

Prayers of Care Inc

Code of Ethics and Conduct

CARF Community Integration (BH) Binder — document ETH-01

DRAFT — do not adopt until the reporting routes in section 'Reporting a concern' are filled in.

Responsible party: Nicky Ingram, Chief Executive Officer / Owner
Signed by every workforce member — and by the CEO
At hire, at any revision, and annually
Status: DRAFT — not yet adopted, not yet effective
Prepared with Successful Solutions

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Version	Draft 1
Status	Draft → Approved → Trained → In use → Tested → Monitoring *(circle the current state)*
Responsible party	Nicky Ingram, Chief Executive Officer / Owner
Approval date	_____
Effective date	_____
Review interval	Annually
Next review due	_____
Signed by	Every workforce member at hire, at any revision, and annually
CARF areas served	1.A Leadership (p.31); 1.J Rights of Persons Served (p.89); 1.I Workforce Development and Management (p.80)

Purpose

Set clear rules for honest, safe, respectful work. Protect the people we serve, the integrity of peer support, and each other.

Who this applies to

Every employee, contractor, student, intern and volunteer of Prayers of Care Inc — **and the CEO / Owner**. An ethics code that the owner does not sign is not a code, it is a staff rule.

Standards of conduct

1. Person-centered respect

- Honour each person's choice, dignity, culture and identity.
- **Do not pressure anyone toward any belief.** Prayers of Care Inc offers no faith-based activity. Spirituality is a domain a person may choose; follow their lead and never introduce religious content unless they ask. See MVV-01, Statement on Faith.
- Respect every recovery pathway equally, including medication for a mental health or substance use condition. Discouraging a person's prescribed medication is a violation of this Code.
- Use inclusive language. Never use "non-compliant" or "resistant" about a person exercising a choice.

2. Honesty and documentation integrity

- Tell the truth, in conversation, in the record and on a claim.
- **Never document a service that did not happen as documented.** Never alter a record to conceal an error. Never bill for a service not delivered as documented.
- Correct an error by amendment, dated and initialled — never by erasing, overwriting or back-dating.
- **Do not claim CARF accreditation until it is awarded.** "Preparing for CARF accreditation" is the accurate description until then. See JD-01 section 5.
- Admit mistakes and fix them. **Reporting your own error is not a disciplinary matter** — hiding one is.

3. Confidentiality and privacy

- Share information only with valid written authorization or where the law requires it.
- Protect paper and electronic records. Nothing containing a person's information is left in a vehicle, on a screen, or in an open bag.
- No conversation about a person served in a public place, a corridor, a car with anyone else present, or any online space.
- **Never confirm or deny that any individual receives services here** — not to a caller, not to a family member, not to anyone, without authorization. Take a number and route it to the Privacy Officer.

4. Peer role integrity

- Use lived experience to help the person, not to centre yourself.
- Follow your written disclosure plan and review disclosure in supervision.
- **Dual relationships are expected in a small recovery community and are not misconduct. Failing to disclose one is.** Disclose in writing by the next business day; your supervisor writes the management plan.

- The full boundary rules are in **JD-02 section 8** and are not repeated here, so the two can never disagree.

5. Money and gifts

- No lending, borrowing or giving money to or from a person served, in any amount, for any reason, ever.
- No gift beyond a token of nominal value. A gift that creates obligation is refused kindly and reported to your supervisor.
- No business or financial arrangement with a person served. Never hold anyone's cash, card, benefits or bank access. Never act as a representative payee. Never co-sign anything.

6. Safety

- Follow emergency, infection-control and community-safety procedures.
- Report incidents, and any suspicion of abuse, neglect or exploitation, immediately.
- No weapons, violence or intimidation.
- **You are never required to enter or remain anywhere you believe is unsafe, and leaving is never grounds for discipline.**

7. Impairment and professionalism

- Do not work under the influence of alcohol or any impairing substance.
- **If your own recovery is under strain, tell your supervisor.** That conversation is supported, not punished — see JD-02 section 10. Working impaired is the violation; asking for help is not.
- Reliable attendance, respectful communication, and dress and conduct suited to community settings.

8. Non-discrimination and non-retaliation

- No discrimination on any basis protected by law.
- **No retaliation** against anyone — staff or person served — for raising a concern in good faith, filing a grievance, or taking part in an investigation, an audit or an accreditation survey. Retaliation is itself a violation of this Code and is investigated as one.

9. Conflicts of interest

- Disclose any actual, potential or perceived conflict in writing, before it can influence a decision.
- Never steer a person served toward a business you or your family benefit from.
- **This applies to the CEO.** Owner conflicts are recorded in the LEAD-01 Decision Log, since there is no board to abstain in front of.

10. Technology and social media

- Use agency systems for authorized work only.
- Never post information about a person served, never post photographs taken during service, and **never confirm or deny that any individual receives services here** — even if they have posted about it themselves.
- Do not accept or send friend or follow requests with a current person served on a personal account. Decline, and mention it at your next supervision.
- Do not respond publicly to an online review or comment from a person served; refer it to the CEO.

11. Mandatory reporting

This is the most legally serious duty in this Code, so it is stated here in full rather than deferred to another document.

- **North Carolina requires reporting by any person who suspects** abuse, neglect or exploitation of a child, or of a disabled or older adult. Confirm the current statutory citation, the receiving agency and the required timeframe: `[FILL IN — confirm with counsel or the county DSS]`
- **You report on suspicion. You do not need proof, and you do not need permission.**
- Tell your supervisor immediately — and if your supervisor is unavailable, or is the subject of the concern, **make the report yourself and tell the CEO afterwards.** The report does not wait for a chain of command.
- The Compliance Officer confirms and records that every required external report was made.
- Reporting in good faith is protected. Nobody is disciplined for a report that turns out to be unfounded.

12. Cooperation with review

Cooperate fully and truthfully with any internal review, payer audit, licensure inspection or

accreditation survey. Do not conceal, alter or destroy a record because a review is coming.

Reporting a concern

Internal routes

1. Your supervisor.
2. The Program Supervisor — `[FILL IN name]`
3. The Compliance Officer — `[FILL IN name]`
4. The CEO / Owner — Nicky Ingram, `[FILL IN phone / email]`

If the concern is about the CEO / Owner, or you would rather not use an internal route

This is the part a code of ethics usually gets wrong. In an owner-operated agency, "report to the Supervisor or the ED" collapses the moment the concern is about the ED — and a route that leads back to the person complained about is not a route.

Route	Contact	Notes
Anonymous internal method	`[FILL IN — e.g. a locked suggestion box at a named location, or a free anonymous web form]`	Must not identify the sender and must not be read only by the CEO
Independent designated person	`[FILL IN — name and contact of someone outside the agency's chain of command]`	Options: the external accountant, the agency's attorney, or the consultant
State licensing authority	`[FILL IN agency and phone]`	
Health plan / MCO	`[FILL IN plan and phone]`	
NC protection and advocacy organization	`[FILL IN]`	
CARF International	`[FILL IN]`	Anyone may contact CARF directly about an accredited or applying organization
Adult or child protective services	`[FILL IN county DSS]`	For abuse, neglect or exploitation

All of these routes are posted where staff and persons served can see them. Not filed — posted.

Decide this before adopting the Code. Pick a real anonymous method and a real independent person, and write them in. Leaving these blank leaves section 8 unenforceable: you cannot promise non-retaliation while the only route runs through the person who might retaliate.

What happens when a concern is raised

1. Logged on receipt, including anonymous reports.
2. Investigated by someone **not involved in the matter**. Where the concern involves the CEO, the independent designated person above handles it.
3. A written finding, with any corrective action, an owner and a due date.
4. The reporter is told the outcome where they are identifiable.
5. Where a violation may affect a peer credential or a professional licence, the matter is reported to that credentialing body as its rules require.
6. Consequences run from coaching through to termination, applied consistently regardless of who the person is.

Procedure

1. Receive this Code at hire, at any revision, and annually.
2. **Ask questions before signing.** Signing is not a formality; if something here is unclear or you disagree with it, say so first.
3. Sign the acknowledgment.
4. Signed copies are filed in the personnel file and tracked below.

Acknowledgment

I have received and read this Code of Ethics and Conduct. I have had the opportunity to ask

questions. I agree to follow it. I understand that violation may lead to corrective action up to termination, and where required a report to a credentialing body.

I specifically understand that I will not enter a romantic or sexual relationship with a person served; will not lend, borrow or give money; will not document a service that did not occur as documented; and will report suspected abuse, neglect or exploitation without delay.

Name: _____ Role: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

Received and filed by: _____ Date: _____

Signature tracking

Name	Role	Signed at hire	Annual re-sign	Annual re-sign	Filed?
Nicky Ingram	CEO / Owner				

Agency check: [] Every current workforce member has signed, and the forms are filed.

Confirmed by: _____ Date: _____

For staff already employed when this Code is adopted: they sign on the day they receive it. Do not backdate to their hire date.

Annual review record

Review due	Completed (date)	Reviewed by	Changes made, or "reviewed, no change"	New version
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What a surveyor will ask

They ask	What has to be true
"Show me a signed Code for every staff member, dated within twelve months."	The tracking table is complete, including the CEO's own signature
Asked of a peer specialist: "If you had a concern about the owner, who would you tell?"	They name a route that does not run through her, without hesitating
"Where is that posted?"	On a wall, not in a binder
"Tell me about an ethics concern that was raised and what happened."	A real example, or a credible account of how one would be handled
"Who reports suspected abuse, and how fast?"	"I do, immediately, on suspicion, and I don't need permission"
"Has anyone been disciplined under this Code?"	An honest answer either way

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